IELTS LISTENING MODULE

Complete Syllabus & Study Guide

1. Module Overview

The IELTS Listening test assesses your ability to understand spoken English in a variety of everyday and academic contexts. It is identical for both Academic and General Training candidates. The test lasts approximately **30 minutes** (plus 10 minutes for transferring answers on paper-based tests). You will hear **four recordings**, each played **once only**.

2. Key Facts at a Glance

3. Test Structure (4 Parts)

Difficulty increases from Part 1 to Part 4. Parts 1–2 focus on social/everyday English; Parts 3–4 move into academic contexts.

4. Question Types

You may encounter any of the following question types (often mixed within a part):

- **Multiple Choice** – choose one or more correct options from a list
- **Matching** – match items from two lists (e.g., speakers to opinions)
- **Plan / Map / Diagram Labelling** – label parts of a visual
- **Form / Note / Table / Flow-chart / Summary Completion** – fill in gaps
- **Sentence Completion** – complete sentences with words from the recording
- **Short-answer Questions** – answer with a word or short phrase

5. Scoring & Band Conversion

Each correct answer earns 1 mark (no negative marking). Raw score out of 40 is converted to a band score. Spelling and grammar must be accurate — incorrect spelling scores zero.

6. Preparation Tips & Strategies

- Read questions carefully in the time given before each recording starts.
- Listen for synonyms and paraphrases — answers are rarely word-for-word.
- Pay attention to signpost language (firstly, however, in contrast, etc.).
- Practise with different accents regularly.
- Never leave a blank — guess if necessary (no penalty).
- Check spelling and singular/plural forms carefully when transferring answers.
- Focus on accuracy in Parts 1–2 and stamina/concentration in Parts 3–4.

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